SUPPORT AFTER SURGERY



Making arrangements in advance to have adequate support at home can help patients return home after surgery as soon as it is appropriate and avoid delays to discharge. [1,2] Traditional criteria for discharge following day surgery includes the presence of a capable adult care-giver for 24 hours postoperatively.

Screening Tools

Screening Questions:

- Do you have someone that can help you during your recovery after surgery if necessary?
- Do you have someone who can take over your caregiving responsibilities while you recover from surgery (e.g., vulnerable adults, children, or pets)?

SUPPORT AFTER SURGERY ALGORITHM

Screening Questions
No capable adult available for the recovery period

Patient Education
- ▶ Importance of support after surgery
- ▶ Set expectations for recovery period

Patient Resources
- ▶ Direct to 211 or gov.bc.ca *(QR code below)* for how to arrange home care

Prehabilitation and Optimization Recommendations

Patient Education	⚙ Advise patients on the importance of post-surgery support and set clear expectations for their recovery ⚙ "Depending on what type of surgery you are having you may need to have someone help you for a while. If the plan is for you to go home the same day (daycare surgery), it is critical that you have someone to assist you on the way home as well as a responsible adult to spend the night with you."
Provide resources for those with no support	⚙ *211 or gov.bc.ca - telephone or online resource to find local home and community care services ⚙ Refer to local social worker